

The Quine-McCluskey Method

Also known as the method of PI.

→ When there are five variables, the K-map method is difficult to apply and completely impractical beyond five.

→ The Quine-McCluskey method is a formal tabular method for applying the Boolean distributive law to various terms to minimum sum of products by eliminating literal that appears in two terms as complements.

It is alternative of K-maps.
It is based on the concept of prime implicants.

Advantage It is systematic for producing a minimal function that is less dependent on visual patterns.

Tabular Method

Simplify the following boolean expression.

$$Y(A, B, C, D) = \sum m(0, 1, 3, 7, 8, 9, 11, 15)$$

Table-1

X	ABCD	No of 1's	Minterm	ABCD
0	0000	0	0	0000
1	0001	1	1	0001
3	0011	2	3	1000
7	0111	3	7	0011
8	1000	1	8	1001
9	1001	2	9	0111
11	1011	3	11	1011
15	1111	4	15	1111

Table-2

Disadvantage:

Computational complexity still remains high.

→ The basic principle is to remove the terms, which are redundant and can be obtained by other terms.

(Table-2)

No of 1's	Minterm	1st level
0	m_0, m_1 m_0, m_8 m_0, m_2	$000x$ $x000 \checkmark$ $00x0 \checkmark$
1	m_2, m_{10} m_8, m_{10} m_8, m_{11}	$x010 \checkmark$ $10x0 \checkmark$ $10x0 \checkmark$
2	m_{10}, m_{11}	$101x \checkmark$
3	m_{11}, m_{15} m_{14}, m_{15}	$1x11 \checkmark$ $111x \checkmark$

Table-3

No of 1's	Minterm	2nd level	Binary
0	m_0, m_8, m_2, m_{10} m_0, m_2, m_8, m_{14}	$x0x0$ $x0x0$	$\bar{B}\bar{D}$
2	$m_{10}, m_{11}, m_{15}, m_{14}$ $m_{11}, m_{15}, m_{10}, m_{14}$	$1x1x$ $1x1x$	AC

PI	Minterm	m_0	m_1	m_2	m_8	m_{10}	m_{11}	m_{14}	m_{15}
$\bar{B}\bar{D}$	0, 8, 2, 10	☒	☐	☒	☒	☒	☐	☐	☐
AC	10, 11, 14, 15	☐	☐	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒	☒
$\bar{A}\bar{B}\bar{C}$	0, 1	☒	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
$\bar{A}\bar{B}C$	0, 1	☒	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
$\bar{A}B\bar{C}$	0, 1	☒	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
$\bar{A}BC$	0, 1	☒	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

$$F(A, B, C, D) = \bar{B}\bar{D} + AC + \bar{A}\bar{B}\bar{C}$$

Don't care w.d. $\bar{A}\bar{B}\bar{C}$ Tabula
include g' term Don't care

K-maps:

for a:

AB \ CD	00	01	11	10
00	1	0	1	1
01	0	1	1	1
11	X	X	X	X
10	1	1	X	X

$$F(ABCD) = \bar{B}\bar{D} + C + \bar{B}D + A$$

for b

AB \ CD	00	01	11	10
00	1	1	1	1
01	1	0	1	0
11	X	X	X	X
10	1	1	X	X

$$F(ABCD) = \bar{B} + \bar{C}\bar{D} + CD$$

for c

AB \ CD	00	01	11	10
00	1	1	1	0
01	1	1	1	1
11	X	X	X	X
10	1	1	X	X

$$F(ABCD) = \bar{C} + D + B$$

AB \ CD	00	01	11	10
00	1	0	1	1
01	0	1	0	1
11	X	X	X	X
10	1	1	X	X

$$F(ABCD) = \bar{B}\bar{D} + \bar{B}C + B\bar{C}D + \bar{C} + A$$

fore

AB \ CD	00	01	11	10
00	1	0	0	1
01	0	0	0	1
11	X	X	X	X
10	1	0	X	X

for g

$$F(ABCD) = \bar{B}\bar{D} + C\bar{D}$$

AB \ CD	00	01	11	10
00	1	0	0	0
01	1	1	0	1
11	X	X	X	X
10	1	1	X	X

$$F(ABCD) = \bar{C}\bar{D} + B\bar{C} + B\bar{D} + A$$

for g

AB \ CD	00	01	11	10
00	0	0	1	1
01	1	1	0	1
11	X	X	X	X
10	1	1	X	X

$$F(ABCD) = \bar{B}C + B\bar{C} + A + B\bar{D}$$